

Action-Prefix Recognition

Instruction (§11.4.140) —

LAYER-1 carrier block

Field	Value
Revision	1
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Scope	the reusable verbatim instruction block embedded into every agent context carrier
Authority	DESIGN.md §5 + RULE_DRAFT.md Part B (this directory)

This file holds the **single canonical LAYER-1 recognition-instruction block**. The conductor (or the §11.4.35 propagation machinery) embeds the block between the two markers below — VERBATIM, identical text — into every agent context carrier the constitution maintains (CLAUDE.md, AGENTS.md, QWEN.md, GEMINI.md). That textual identity across all four carriers IS the LAYER-1 universality: every CLI agent reads the same instruction via its own carrier and applies the prefix expansion itself (per §11.4.35), so the system works on every agent with zero extra setup.

The block is self-contained: even an agent with NO registry-file access still has the most-used BACKGROUND expansion inline, while the registry (actions/registry.yaml) remains the extensible source of truth for every other action.

NOTE: this is the canonical block text. It is NOT applied to the live governance files (CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md / QWEN.md / GEMINI.md) by this machinery — those are conductor-owned (§11.4.58 contention paths). The operator lands it via the §11.4.26 constitution-update pipeline.

§11.4.140 — Universal action-prefix system (ACTION_NAME ::) (User mandate, 2026-06-09; GRAMMAR_ADDENDUM 2026-06-09). When a user

prompt's FIRST non-blank line starts with a recognised action prefix, you MUST: (1) look the action token up in the action registry constitution/actions/registry.yaml (or \$HELIX_ACTION_REGISTRY); (2) if it is a registered action, REPLACE the prefix with that action's expansion text and apply its rules; (3) execute the remainder of the prompt under the expanded instruction. **Four EQUIVALENT forms** — same action, same expansion, same execution: (1) ACTION_NAME :: <rest> (bare ::), (2) PREFIX::ACTION_NAME :: <rest> (namespaced ::), (3) /ACTION_NAME <rest> (bare slash), (4) /PREFIX::ACTION_NAME <rest> (namespaced slash). Thus BACKGROUND :: x ≡ DEFAULT::BACKGROUND :: x ≡ /BACKGROUND x ≡ /DEFAULT::BACKGROUND x. PREFIX is an action NAMESPACE; the reserved default namespace is **DEFAULT**, and an action runs WITH or WITHOUT the prefix. Grammar (all hold): anchored at the FIRST non-blank line only (mid-prose tokens never match); the action token AND the namespace are UPPERCASE-only [A-Z][A-Z0-9_]* (lowercase never matches); the namespace separator :: inside the token carries NO surrounding spaces (PREFIX::ACTION_NAME), DISTINCT from the action-body separator " :: " (one ASCII space on each side of :: — avoids C++ Foo::Bar, YAML key: value, URLs) in forms 1/2 and the slash-body separator (one space) in forms 3/4; stacked prefixes (A :: B :: rest) apply outer-to-inner, left-to-right (expand A, re-scan, expand B, then the residual is the task); a leading \ escapes the prefix for BOTH the :: and the slash form (\BACKGROUND :: x, \ / BACKGROUND x — treat literally, strip the backslash, NO expansion) so action names can be discussed. **Conflict rule (slash form):** /ACTION_NAME (form 3) is honored as the action ONLY when ACTION_NAME (case-folded) does not collide with a built-in/host slash command (registry slash_bare: auto + slash_conflicts: [...]); form 4 (/PREFIX::ACTION_NAME) is ALWAYS unambiguous and always honored. An unknown token that matches the grammar shape (any of the 4 forms) but is NOT registered is NEVER silently expanded or silently dropped — ask which registered action was meant (§11.4.66 / §11.4.105) or treat it as a literal prompt, NEVER invent an expansion (§11.4.6); any prompt not satisfying the grammar is an ordinary prompt and the system is a no-op. The registered action **BACKGROUND** expands to: *“The following prompt that we will provide MUST BE executed in background in parallel with all main work streams using the subagents-driven development approach! All work done MUST PRODUCE rock solid evidence covered with hard physical proof(s) that all done is working as expected and as specified without any false results and without any bluff!”* (composes §11.4.20 / §11.4.70 subagent-driven, §11.4.58 / §11.4.103 parallel streams, §11.4.89 background execution, §11.4.5 / §11.4.69 / §11.4.107 captured physical evidence, §11.4 anti-bluff). The system is UNIVERSAL (every CLI agent reads this block via its context carrier per §11.4.35),

extensible (new action = new registry row), decoupled + reusable (§11.4.28), and loads out-of-the-box. Classification: universal (§11.4.17). **Canonical authority:** constitution submodule Constitution.md §11.4.140. Non-compliance is a release blocker. No escape hatch — no --skip-action-prefix, --ignore-prefix, --no-registry, --invent-expansion-OK, --single-layer-only flag.